

June 7 Lesson Plan Outline

My Heart Rejoiceth in the Lord

Scriptures: Ruth; 1 Samuel 1-7

Main message: God can guide, comfort, redeem, and speak to us during grief, uncertainty, waiting, and difficult times.

Opening

Ask:

When have you seen the Lord help someone through a hard or unexpected situation?

Explain:

As we study Ruth, Hannah, Samuel, and Israel, look for what each story teaches us about trusting the Lord.

1. Ruth: Christ Can Turn Tragedy Into Triumph

Brief introduction: Ruth and Naomi had both experienced serious loss. Naomi's husband and sons had died, and Ruth was one of Naomi's widowed daughters-in-law. When Naomi decided to return to Bethlehem, Ruth had to choose whether to go back to her own people or stay with Naomi and trust the God of Israel.

Read: Ruth 1:16-17; Ruth 2:11-12; Ruth 4:13-17

Video slide: Ruth and Naomi

Teaching points:

- Ruth and Naomi both experienced deep loss.
- Ruth chose loyalty, covenant belonging, and faith in the God of Israel.
- Boaz became a redeemer for Ruth and Naomi.
- Ruth became part of the family line of King David and Jesus Christ.
- The Lord can turn painful chapters into part of His larger work of redemption.

Discussion questions:

- What did Ruth sacrifice by staying with Naomi?
- What does Ruth's statement in Ruth 1:16-17 teach us about covenant loyalty?
- What does it mean to trust "under [the Lord's] wings"?
- How does Boaz point us toward Jesus Christ?
- How can Christ help us during grief, even before everything is healed?

Simple summary: Ruth chose God before she knew how her story would end.

2. Hannah: God Hears Honest Prayer

Brief introduction: Hannah was deeply sorrowful because she had no children and was treated cruelly because of it. She went to the temple and poured out her soul to the Lord. Her story teaches us about prayer, waiting, and finding peace even before every answer comes.

Read: 1 Samuel 1:9-18; 1 Samuel 2:1-2

Video slide: Hannah's Faith

Teaching points:

- Hannah brought her sorrow honestly to the Lord.
- She prayed "in bitterness of soul," showing that sincere prayer can include pain.
- Her circumstances did not change immediately, but her heart did.
- After praying, "her countenance was no more sad."
- God heard Hannah, and her song in chapter 2 shows rejoicing in the Lord.

Discussion questions:

- What do you notice about Hannah's prayer?
- Why is it important that we can bring sorrow, not just gratitude, to God?
- What changed in Hannah before the blessing came?
- What does faith look like while we are still waiting?
- How can prayer help us carry trials that are not removed right away?

Simple summary: Hannah teaches us that peace can come before the answer comes.

3. Samuel: "Speak; for Thy Servant Heareth"

Brief introduction: Samuel was the son Hannah had prayed for. She dedicated him to the Lord, and he served in the temple under Eli. One night, Samuel heard a voice calling his name, but he did not yet recognize that it was the Lord.

Read: 1 Samuel 3:1-10

Video slide: Samuel and Eli

Teaching points:

- Samuel was serving in the temple, but he still had to learn to recognize the Lord's voice.
- The Lord called Samuel more than once.
- Eli helped Samuel understand what was happening.
- Revelation often requires listening, practice, and willingness to obey.
- Samuel's response shows humility: "Speak; for thy servant heareth."

Discussion questions:

- Why do you think Samuel did not recognize the Lord's voice at first?
- Who has helped you learn how revelation feels or sounds?
- What makes it hard to hear the Lord today?

- What can we do to become better listeners?
- What would it mean this week to say, "Speak; for thy servant heareth"?

Simple activity: Give everyone a card or paper and ask them to complete this sentence:

This week I can better hear the Lord by _____.

Simple summary: Samuel teaches us that hearing the Lord is something we can learn.

4. Israel and the Ark: Symbols Do Not Replace Obedience

Brief introduction: In 1 Samuel 4, Israel was losing a battle against the Philistines. Instead of repenting and seeking the Lord, they brought the ark of the covenant into battle, thinking the sacred object itself would save them. Later, Samuel taught them that they needed to return to the Lord with their whole hearts.

Read: 1 Samuel 4:3; 1 Samuel 7:3-6

Teaching points:

- Israel brought the ark into battle as if the object itself would save them.
- They wanted God's power without fully turning their hearts to Him.
- Samuel later taught them to return to the Lord, put away false gods, and serve Him only.
- Sacred symbols and habits matter, but they cannot replace real conversion.
- Hope in Christ leads us to repentance, trust, and obedience.

Discussion questions:

- Why was having the ark not enough to save Israel?
- What did Samuel ask the people to change?
- What are some modern examples of relying on outward religious habits without fully turning to God?
- How do ordinances, scriptures, temples, and covenants help us come unto Christ?
- What is one way we can return to the Lord with our whole hearts?

Simple summary: The Lord wants our hearts, not just our outward religious symbols.

5. Wheel of Fortune Activity

Timing: Last 20-30 minutes

Setup: Break the class into 3 teams. Use the Wheel of Fortune activity running at <http://localhost:4173/>.

Purpose: Review the lesson principles in a high-energy way while reinforcing scripture phrases, people, places, and applications from Ruth and 1 Samuel.

Scripture Phrases

- WHITHER THOU GOEST I WILL GO
- THY PEOPLE SHALL BE MY PEOPLE
- THY GOD MY GOD
- UNDER WHOSE WINGS THOU ART COME TO TRUST

- MY HEART REJOICETH IN THE LORD
- SPEAK LORD FOR THY SERVANT HEARETH
- RETURN UNTO THE LORD WITH ALL YOUR HEARTS
- THE LORD REMEMBERED HER
- HER COUNTENANCE WAS NO MORE SAD
- PREPARE YOUR HEARTS UNTO THE LORD

People and Places

- RUTH AND NAOMI
- HANNAH AND SAMUEL
- SAMUEL AND ELI
- BOAZ THE REDEEMER
- BETHLEHEM
- THE ARK OF THE COVENANT
- THE HOUSE OF THE LORD
- THE LAND OF MOAB
- THE PHILISTINES
- KING DAVID

Lesson Principles

- GOD HEARS HONEST PRAYER
- FAITH WHILE WAITING
- LOYALTY DURING HARD TIMES
- CHRIST CAN REDEEM OUR STORY
- LISTEN FOR THE LORDS VOICE
- CHOOSE FAITH OVER FEAR
- TRUST GOD BEFORE YOU KNOW THE ENDING
- SACRED THINGS POINT US TO CHRIST
- THE LORD WANTS OUR HEARTS
- PEACE CAN COME BEFORE THE ANSWER

Trials and Hope

- WHEN LIFE DOES NOT GO AS PLANNED
- FINDING HOPE AFTER LOSS
- COMFORT IN DIFFICULT TIMES
- THE SAVIOR WALKS WITH US
- GRIEF IS NOT THE END OF THE STORY
- GOD CAN TURN SORROW INTO JOY
- KEEP MOVING FORWARD WITH FAITH
- THE LORD IS NEAR TO THE BROKENHEARTED
- TRUSTING GOD IN UNCERTAINTY
- WAITING UPON THE LORD

Final Round Ideas

- JESUS CHRIST IS OUR REDEEMER
- SPEAK LORD FOR THY SERVANT HEARETH
- GOD CAN TURN SORROW INTO REJOICING
- TRUST THE LORD WITH YOUR WHOLE HEART
- MY HEART REJOICETH IN THE LORD

Suggested flow:

- Use easier puzzles first, such as RUTH AND NAOMI or GOD HEARS HONEST PRAYER.
- Use longer scripture phrases in the middle rounds.
- Save one final-round puzzle for the end.

Closing Discussion

Ask:

What do Ruth, Hannah, Samuel, and Israel each teach us about trusting the Lord?

Possible answers:

- Ruth teaches covenant loyalty.
- Hannah teaches honest prayer.
- Samuel teaches listening for revelation.
- Israel teaches wholehearted repentance.
- All of them point us to Jesus Christ.

Closing Testimony

These chapters show that the Lord is present in grief, waiting, uncertainty, and correction. Ruth did not know how her story would end. Hannah did not receive her answer immediately. Samuel had to learn how to recognize the Lord's voice. Israel had to learn to return to the Lord with full purpose of heart. In each case, God was inviting His children to trust Him. Jesus Christ is our Redeemer, our comfort, and the One who can turn sorrow into rejoicing.

Invitation

Invite everyone to choose one action this week:

- Trust God like Ruth.
- Pray honestly like Hannah.
- Listen like Samuel.
- Return to the Lord with your whole heart like Israel.